the MI representative to the Mossad was with each and every source. This officer was also the first to see the raw intelligence material that came in and was privy to all of the secrets of the Mossad's sources. Later, another section, Modi'in 12, whose function was identical to Modi'in 11's, was established within the unit dealing with friendly intelligence services.

A periodic assessment of the Mossad's sources was carried out by MI research officers—the consumers of the material. These officers were regularly involved in the investigation of Mossad sources abroad and in talks with analysts from the friendly intelligence services. The Mossad disseminated all the information it collected to MI, without exception. On the other hand, Military Intelligence distributed the products of its research and evaluation to the Mossad selectively— very selectively. The choice of what to disseminate appeared to be almost arbitrary and was always explained as being due to reasons of "information security." As a result of the situation I have described, in practice the Mossad was prevented from dealing with research and evaluation, even with regard to the information collected by itself, and certainly with regard to information gathered by the intelligence community.

The analysis I propose in this chapter regarding the progression of the early warning of the Yom Kippur War challenges the prevailing thesis of the public and media discourse on this war. In my analysis, the early warning of the Yom Kippur War was a rolling, continuous event that had an ample basis in intelligence collected over the years, which reached its peak on the eve of the outbreak of the war.

In my capacity as a head of the Operations Directorate, my attention was directed mainly toward the activity of the Mossad's operational units and less, if at all, toward the intelligence products of this activity. However, I remember that beginning in mid-1973, especially in the forum of the Mossad's unit heads, more and more surprise was expressed about the fact that Military Intelligence did not agree with, or take seriously, the growing mass of intelligence from the Mossad's sources that indicated a deterioration toward war. At least some of the heads of the units around the table believed that Military Intelligence must have had other serious sources that contradicted Mossad intelligence. The feeling of those in the forum was that we needed to focus on how to bring higher-quality intelligence without engaging in the research and evaluation of this intelligence, which was not